

The Boston Globe

Serving our community since 1872

WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2025

At Harvard, Hegseth sang a different tune on DEI

Now a hard-line defense secretary, he struck a gentler tone in thesis

By Deirdre Fernandes and Stephanie Ebbert

GLOBE STAFF

Before he became a top Trump administration attack dog on all things DEI, Secretary of Defense Pete Hegseth was a Harvard University master's degree candidate who described closing racial achievement gaps as a "laudable goal," backed "equality, diversity, and accessibility," and saw the necessity of working with Democrats.

Hegseth's 2013 thesis for the Kennedy School of Government, a copy of which was obtained by the Globe, displays a moderation absent from Hegseth's current persona. His role as a culture warrior in President Trump's Cabinet was embodied in a speech last week in which he declared the military wouldn't tolerate "more identity months, DEI offices, dudes in dresses."

Compare that language with his 45-page paper from a dozen years ago, when he was pursuing a master's in public policy from the nation's oldest university. "Ensuring low-income and minority children have the same opportunities as more affluent majority students is an essential goal and worth pursuing with vigor and substantial investment," Hegseth wrote then. "Our country and state must strive for equal opportunity for all, regardless of race, class, geography, or gender."

Back then, Hegseth was promoting the idea

HEGSETH, Page A6

Shaheen looks for common ground on shutdown

By Jim Puzzanghera

GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — If lawmakers can strike a deal to quickly end the the federal government shutdown, it may be due in part to the quiet work of New Hampshire Senator Jeanne Shaheen, who has become a key player in back-channel discussions for a bipartisan compromise.

The 16-year veteran Democrat is among a small number of senators talking with colleagues across the aisle about finding a way to reopen the government while addressing the Democrats' top priority: extending tax credits for Affordable Care Act health insurance premiums that expire on Dec. 31.

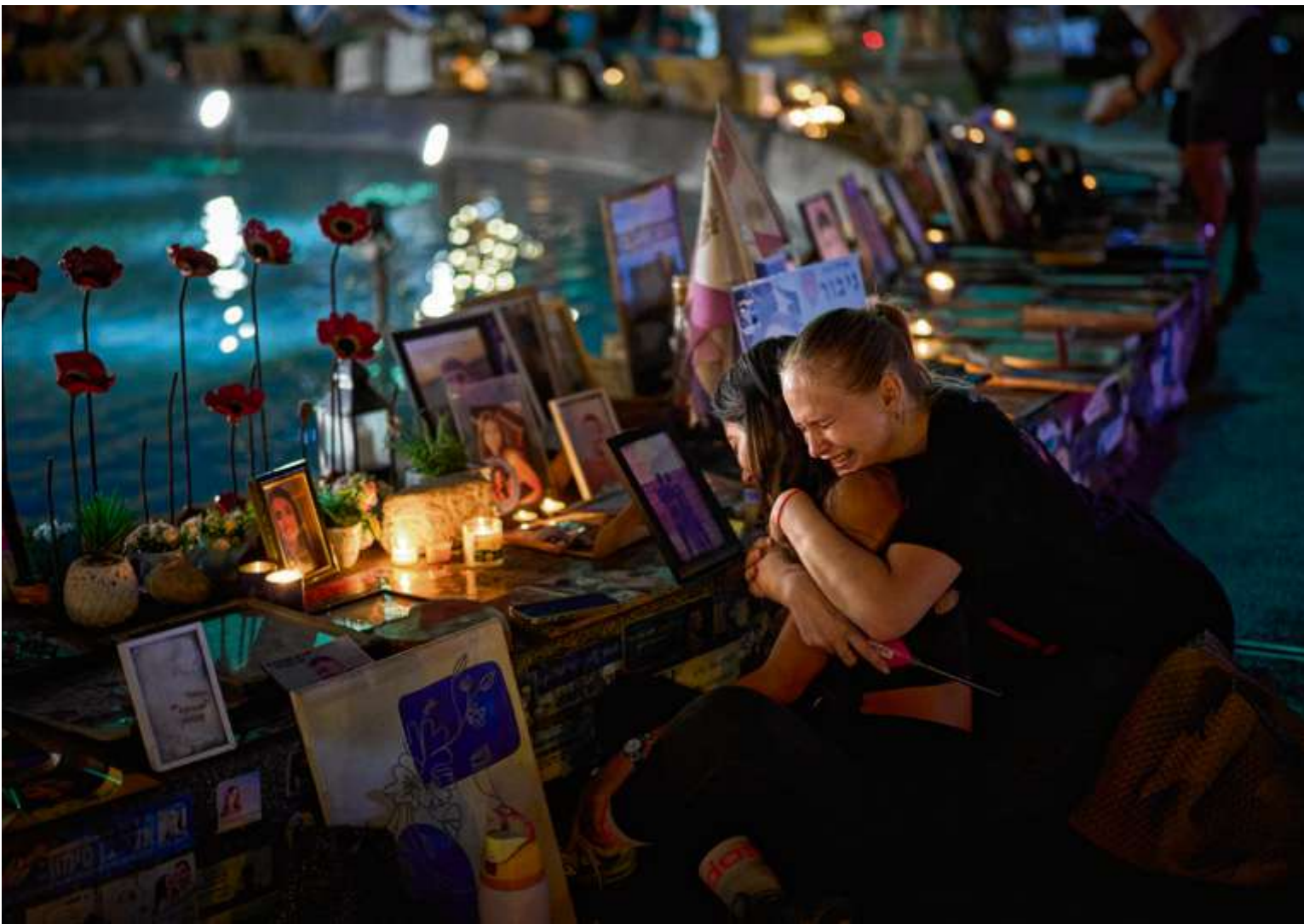
Since the shutdown began on Oct. 1, Shaheen has made multiple TV appearances, including on Fox News, pressing the case for a deal without getting into specifics. At the same time, she's been involved in private talks with individual Republican senators, although she's been publicly mum on what a deal might look like when pressed by reporters on Capitol Hill. The maneuvering comes as leaders of both parties have dug in on their demands.

"I've been having conversations with my fel-

SHAHEEN, Page A7

On Oct. 7, Israel remembers

After two years, a renewed call to bring hostages home, but war continues



EMILIO MORENATTI/ASSOCIATED PRESS

At a memorial in Tel Aviv on Tuesday, two people embraced near photos of Israelis killed in the Hamas attack in 2023.

By David M. Halbfinger

NEW YORK TIMES

TEL AVIV — In subdued fashion Tuesday, Israel marked the second anniversary of the Hamas-led attack that began its longest war, with new hopes of ending the conflict but with hostages still in captivity and its exhausted military adding to the death toll of Palestinians and to the destruction in the Gaza Strip.

The arrival of the Jewish harvest festival, Sukkot, a national and religious holiday, shut down most businesses across Israel for

the day. The government delayed official remembrances of the war's traumatic first day until Oct. 16, after the High Holiday season.

But Tuesday's milestone was inescapable.

There were quiet gatherings at some of the kibbutzim near Gaza that suffered the most in the massacres of Oct. 7, 2023, and informal events drew participants throughout the country.

Many Israelis say that the sun has still not set on that October day. At nightfall Tuesday, tens of thousands of people gathered in

Tel Aviv's central park for the anniversary's main memorial event, an emotional ceremony organized by families of the victims that was screened live on national television and at dozens of locations around the country and abroad.

Earlier Tuesday, hundreds of Israelis came to Hostages Square in the center of Tel Aviv, silently meditating over art installations and memorials to those still captive and citizens killed on Oct. 7 or while in captivity. Israel believes that about 20 living hostages are still being held in Gaza

along with the remains of 28 others who died in captivity.

Ilana Yahav, 69, a therapist, said Oct. 7 had opened so many wounds that it was impossible to care for everyone who was suffering.

"If you were there, or someone in your family was there, or you only saw a video — it will be a lot of years of treatment," she said.

Tzliel Sasson, 38, and her husband had driven from Lehavim, east of Gaza, with their three young children.

MIDEAST, Page A5

Scholars see growing danger as Trump escalates troop use

By Matt Stout and Samantha J. Gross

GLOBE STAFF

The development almost carried an air of news-cycle normalcy. President Trump's administration again said it would send National Guard troops to a Democrat-led place, this time to Illinois. Officials there — as those in California, Washington, D.C., and Oregon before them — filed a lawsuit. Judges yet again must weigh the limits of Trump's authority.

That numbing headline drumbeat conceals what some legal and military scholars perceive as a seismic tremor: an unprecedented erosion of con-

stitutional limits and checks designed to prevent the deployment of the United States military against its own citizens.

"I thought we were in a constitutional crisis eight months

►Mass. leaders discuss potential Guard deployment. B1.

ago," said Kent Greenfield, a constitutional law professor at Boston College. His fears have only grown with Trump's latest attempt to send National Guard troops — this time from California or Texas — to Portland, Ore., and Illinois in what he called an "extremely dangerous" escalation.

The courts have acted as checks on Trump's deployments, Greenfield said, but they also have regularly struggled to keep pace with the administration's blitz of actions.

"The courts do not have their own army," Greenfield said. "These are the kinds of acts that can be a flashpoint of violence, for state-versus-state violence. And we have a president who is unconcerned with constraint."

While the action is playing out elsewhere, Massachusetts leaders are paying close attention, given that Boston and its stance on immigration have

MILITARY, Page A6

"Trump is going to push and push until someone pushes back on him and pushes back hard."

SEAN KEALY, BU law professor



ERIN HOOLEY/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Military personnel wearing the Texas National Guard patch gathered Tuesday at the Army Reserve Center in Elwood, Ill.

Pros and cons of rent control on display in Portland, Maine

Lessons for Providence as it considers a similar step

By Steph Machado

GLOBE STAFF

PORTLAND, Maine — When Bradley Davis got his lease renewal offer in 2024, his landlords said he and his partner had been "stellar" tenants during the year they had rented the one-bedroom apartment.

Still, the landlords raised the rent by nearly 7 percent, from \$1,950 to \$2,085 per month. Davis knew Portland had recently implemented rent control, and started looking into it.

His landlords had never registered the unit with the city, so he couldn't see the rent history, but he did have the phone number of the previous tenant. So he asked: How much was your rent when you lived here?

The answer: \$1,600. Davis's landlords had raised the rent on his unit by 22 percent before

he moved in, well beyond the city's allowed limits. The 7 percent increase for the renewal was also above the 2 percent allowed that year.

When he brought it up to his landlords, Davis said, they rescinded their offer for a new lease.

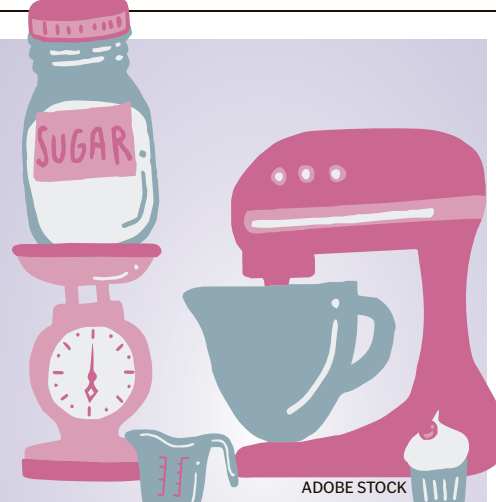
Davis filed a complaint, and after a battle before Portland's rent board, he won. The landlords, who live in California, were ordered to pay him \$4,200 in back rent. The owners denied retaliating against Davis, and settled with him for an additional \$12,300 to get him to move out, according to public records reviewed by the Globe.

"I don't think anybody would be paying an affordable rent if we didn't have rent control," Davis said. The experience prompted him to co-

RENT CONTROL, Page A10


Puttin' on the spritz

Wednesday: A bit of rain.
High 68-73. Low 45-50.
Thursday: Cooling down.
High 56-61. Low 40-45.
High tide: 12:10 a.m., 12:27 p.m.
Sunrise: 6:49 Sunset: 6:13
Weather and Comics, G6-7.


Weighing metric measurements

Using grams, not cups, can make baking more precise. Although it's not always that simple. **G1.**

Governor Maura Healey pledged to crack down on "street take-overs" after several over the weekend. B1.

Attorney General Pam Bondi deflected questions at a combative congressional hearing over allegations that she's weaponizing the agency. A2.

"Young boomer" Larry Edelman shares some perspective on the experiences of Generation Jones. B5.

VOL. 308, NO. 100
*
Suggested retail price
\$4.00


0 947725 4